

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr F Burney

Address: 5A Cornwall Road Cheam SM2 6DR

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing as a local resident and a parent of a young family to express my strong support for planning application DM2025/01591.

Having reviewed the proposals, I believe this development represents a thoughtful and much-needed investment in our neighborhood. My support is based on the following key points:

1. Essential Provisions for Families and Youth

As a parent, I am particularly impressed by the focus on education and childcare. The inclusion of a crèche and a dedicated kids' program addresses a significant gap in local services. Furthermore, Sutton's youth facilities have long lacked adequate investment; the proposed youth-focused spaces provide a safe, constructive environment for the next generation.

2. Health, Sports, and Well-being

The emphasis on physical and mental health is a standout feature of this application. I am very supportive of the:

- Sports and well-being facilities: Providing local options for physical activity.
- Health and well-being sessions: Offering structured support for the community's overall health.
- Publicly available defibrillator: This is a vital, life-saving addition to our street that provides peace of mind for all residents.

3. Inclusive and Sensitive Design

The layout of the center-thoughtfully divided into three distinct halls (a dedicated women's space, a multi-use community space, and a prayer hall)-demonstrates a commitment to inclusivity. I

specifically value the dedicated space for women, which ensures that all members of our community feel comfortable and represented.

4. Consideration for the Neighborhood

The applicant has clearly gone to great lengths to mitigate any impact on local infrastructure:

- Traffic Management: I am pleased to see that prayer timings have been staggered to avoid any overlap with the busy pick-up and drop-off times at Avenue Primary Academy.
- Parking & Sustainable Transport: The addition of dedicated parking spaces and bike racks is a proactive approach to managing local road use.
- Operational Hours: Transitioning from a former 24-hour facility to a community hub with restricted hours is a significant win for local residents.

5. Aesthetic and Environmental Integration

The design is modest and sympathetic, aligning well with the existing character of the street scene. I also appreciate the commitment to maintaining existing greenery and plants, ensuring the site remains soft and integrated into the suburban landscape.

6. Alignment with Strategic Policy

This application is strongly supported by both local and regional planning frameworks:

- London Plan (2021) Policy S1 (Social Infrastructure): The proposal provides high-quality, inclusive social infrastructure that meets a documented local need. It specifically follows the London Plan's encouragement for the co-location of services and the shared use of facilities to use land more efficiently.
- London Plan (2021) Policy S3 & S5: By providing dedicated childcare (S3) and sports/recreation facilities (S5), the project directly contributes to the "Healthy Streets" and "Good Growth" objectives.
- Sutton Local Plan (2018) Policy 25: This development fulfills the council's objective to protect and enhance community facilities. It ensures that the borough's social infrastructure keeps pace with its growing population.
- Sutton Local Plan Policy 33 & 36: The retention of greenery and focus on site landscaping aligns with the borough's commitment to urban greening and biodiversity.

In conclusion, I believe this center will be a fantastic asset to our community. It offers a balanced approach to modernizing our local amenities while remaining deeply respectful of its neighbors. I urge the planning committee to approve this application.